Ethan Hurwitz, Ph.D.

University of California, San Diego
Department of Psychology

ehurwitz@ucsd.edu | www.EthanHurwitz.com | EthanHurwitz

Academic Positions

Sep 2024 — Present
Lecturer, University of California, San Diego
Department of Psychology

Sep 2025 — Present
Lecturer, University of California, San Diego
Department of Human Developmental Sciences

Sep 2026 — Present
Lecturer, University of San Diego
Department of Psychology

Education

Aug 2024
Ph.D., Experimental Psychology, University of California, San Diego
Supervisors: Dr. Caren Walker & Dr. Adena Schachner
Dissertation title: *Cognitive Development as a Model for the Effects of Psychedelics: Do Changes in Cognitive Flexibility Underly the Clinical Benefits of Psychedelic Therapy?*

Dec 2019
M.A., Experimental Psychology, University of California, San Diego

May 2013
B.S., Psychology, Towson University
Summa Cum Laude | GPA: 3.92

Grants and Funding

2023
UCSD Center for Psychedelic Research's Research Excellence Fellowship ($31,000), Cognitive Development as a Model for the Effects of Psychedelics.
Supervisor: Caren Walker

2021
UCSD Chancellor's Interdisciplinary Collaboratories ($30,000), Cognitive and Neural Mechanisms Underlying Psilocybin-Assisted Therapy for Phantom Limb Pain.
Supervisor: Caren Walker

2020
UCSD Course Development and Instructional Improvement Program ($4,836), Enhancing the Psychology core methods curriculum: a new emphasis on computational literacy, open-science practices, and project-based collaboration.
Supervisor: Drs. Judy Fan, Emma Geller, Celeste Pilegard

Awards and Honors

2023
2023 UCSD Anderson Teaching Award

2022
Barbara and Paul Saltman Excellent Teaching Award for Graduate Students

2019
Norman Anderson Summer Research Fellowship

Norman Anderson Graduate Travel and Research Award

Cognitive Science Society Student Travel Award, The 41st Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

2026 J. G. Dean, **E. S. Hurwitz**, T. Furnish, J. Castellanos, A. McKinty, B. Farrell, S. Knatz Peck, J. Trim, E. Samadhi, G. Renwick, R. Mudge, D. Barrows, C. Vieten, B. Cuccurazzu, P. Coleman, A. Lin, M. A. Geyer, F. Zeidan, A. L. Halberstadt (2026). Feasibility and Tolerability of Psilocybin for Phantom Limb Pain. *The Journal of Pain, , .* https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jpain.2026.106404.

E. S. Hurwitz, J. Dean, C. M. Walker (2026). Can Childhood be Used as a Model to Understand the Effects of Psychedelics?. *Topics in Cognitive Science, ,* e70058. https://doi.org/10.1111/tops.70058.

2022 M. M. Sweeney, S. Nayak, **E. S. Hurwitz**, L. N. Mitchell, T. Cody Swift, R. R. Griffiths (2022). Comparison of Psychedelic and Near-Death or Other Non-Ordinary Experiences in Changing Attitudes About Death and Dying. *PloS one, 17 (8),* e0271926. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0271926.

2020 A. K. Davis, J. M. Clifton, E. G. Weaver, **E. S. Hurwitz**, M. W. Johnson, R. R. Griffiths (2020). Survey of entity encounter experiences occasioned by inhaled N,N-dimethyltryptamine: Phenomenology, interpretation, and enduring effects. *Journal of Psychopharmacology, 34 (9),* 1008-1020. https://doi.org/10.1177/0269881120916143.

2019 R. R .Griffiths, **E. S. Hurwitz**, A. K. Davis, M. W. Johnson, R. Jesse (2019). Survey of subjective "God encounter experiences": Comparisons among naturally occurring experiences and those occasioned by the classic psychedelics psilocybin, LSD, ayahuasca, or DMT. *PloS one, 14 (4),* e0214377. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0214377.

2018 F. S. Barrett, T. M. Carbonaro, **E. S. Hurwitz**, M. W. Johnson, R. R. Griffiths (2018). Double-blind comparison of the two hallucinogens psilocybin and dextromethorphan: effects on cognition. *Psychopharmacology, 235 (10),* 2915-2927. https://doi.org/10.1007/s00213-018-4981-x.

T. M. Carbonaro, M. W. Johnson, **E. S. Hurwitz**, R. R. Griffiths (2018). Double-blind comparison of the two hallucinogens psilocybin and dextromethorphan: similarities and differences in subjective experiences. *Psychopharmacology, 235 (2),* 521-534. https://doi.org/10.1007/s00213-017-4769-4.

Under Review **E. S. Hurwitz**, E. Brockback, C. M. Walker (Under Review). Contexto: A New Approach to Measure Flexible Reasoning Under Dynamic Constraints.

Peer-Reviewed Conference Publications

2019 **E. S. Hurwitz**, T. Brady, A. Schachner (2019). Detecting social transmission in the design of artifacts via inverse planning. *Proceedings of the 41st Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*, 457-463. Montreal, CA: Cognitive Science Society.

Conference Presentations

Oral Presentations

2023 **E. S. Hurwitz** (2023). Positive Programming: Effective Course Design and Assignments for Accessible Programming Courses. *PsychTERMS 2023*, Virtual Meeting.

2019 **E. S. Hurwitz**, T. Brady, A. Schachner (2019). Detecting Social Transmission in the Design of Artifacts Via Inverse Planning. *Cognitive Science Society*, Montreal, QC.

Poster Presentations

2024 J. G. Dean, **E. S. Hurwitz**, D. Barrows, A. Mckinty, B. Farrell, J. Castellanos, T. Furnish, P. Coleman, C. Vieten, G. Riegner, L. Khatib, S. Knatz, J. Trim, E. Samadhi, G. Renwick, R. Mudge, A. Lin, M. Geyer, A. Halberstadt, F. Zeidan (2024). Psilocybin-based Therapy for Chronic Phantom Limb Pain. *IASP World Congress on Pain*, Amsterdam, The Netherlands.

E. S. Hurwitz, J. Dean, B. Farrell, A. Mckinty, E. Brockbank, A. Gopnik, C. Walker (2024). A Cognitive Development Model of the Effects of Psychedelics. *Society for Philosophy and Psychology*, West Lafayette, IN.

2020 **E. S. Hurwitz**, A. Schachner (2020). People use inverse planning to rationally seek social information from objects. *Cognitive Science Society*, Virtual Meeting.

2018 A. K. Davis, J. M. Clifton, **E. S. Hurwitz**, R. R. Griffiths (2018). Examining the acute subjective and persisting effects occasioned by N,N-dimethyltryptamine (DMT): A latent class analysis. *Johns Hopkins Bayview Research Symposium*, Baltimore, MD.

2017 **E. S. Hurwitz**, R. Jesse, M. W. Johnson, R. R. Griffiths (2017). A comparison of psilocybin-occasioned vs. naturally-occurring experiences of personal encounters with the divine. *Psychedelic Science*, Oakland, CA.

Invited Talks

2017 The Mycological Association Of Washington, DC. – *An overview of psilocybin research at Johns Hopkins University* (Mar 2017)

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record

PSYC 1 - Introduction to Psychology
Summer 2024, Spring 2025, Summer 2025, Fall 2025

PSYC 193L - Introduction to R for Social Sciences
Summer 2022 x2, Fall 2022, Summer 2023 x2, Winter 2025, Summer 2025, Spring 2026

PSYC 111a - Honors Research Methods
Winter 2023

PSYC 111b - Honors Research Methods II
Spring 2023

PSYC 181 - Drugs and Behavior
Fall 2024, Summer 2025, Winter 2026, Spring 2027

PSYC 70 - Research Methods in Psychology
Fall 2026

PSYC 71 - Laboratory in Psychological Research Methods
Winter 2027

HDS 181 - Experimental Projects in Human Development Research
Fall 2025, Winter 2026, Spring 2026, Fall 2026, Winter 2027, Spring 2027

Teaching Assistanceships

PSYC 60 - Introduction to Statistics
Summer 2018, Fall 2018, Summer 2019, Fall 2019

PSYC 111a - Honors Research Methods
Winter 2020, Winter 2021, Winter 2022, Winter 2024

PSYC 111b - Honors Research Methods II
Spring 2020, Spring 2021, Spring 2022, Spring 2024

Senior TA

Sep 2019 — Jul 2023

University of California, San Diego
Department of Psychology

Summary of Responsibilities:
– Be a source of information to the graduate community and to aid in any TA issues
– Coordinate departmental TA training each academic quarter and as needed
– Coordinate Mentor TAs and provide training on assisting their mentees on their lecture and providing feedback on the lecture
– Organize practice talks for first year graduate students
– Handle TA conflicts

Service, Outreach, and Professional Activities

Reviewer:

Cognitive Science Society; Journal of Psychoactive Drugs; John Templeton Foundation; Topics in Cognitive Science

Clinical Experience

Research Program Coordinator

Jan 2014 — Sep 2017

Johns Hopkins University Behavioral Pharmacology Research Unit
Supervisor: Dr. Roland Griffiths
Effects of Hallucinogens and Other Drugs on Mood and Performance (NCT02033707)
Effects of Psilocybin-facilitated Experience on the Psychology and Effectiveness of Professional Leaders in Religion (NCT02243813)

– Serve as Session Monitor, providing clinical support and administering cognitive tasks to participants during active psilocybin and placebo drug sessions
– Design novel study instruments
– Manage all data collection
– Coordinate all study related responsibilities including communication between participants, study team members, and different study sites
– Manage recruitment and advertising utilizing Google AdWords, Facebook Advertising, Website listings, Listervs, Magazine ads, and Radio ads